

Blogger—the platform—is not freely available, it can be freely used at blogger.com. Confused? To add to it, there are blog hosts offering custom blog platforms who offer their services for free, like blogdrive.com. In such cases it is difficult to distinguish between the platform and the host. In most cases such free services are ad-supported, meaning you will have the host's ads on your blog page.

Needless to say, the platforms also differ in the features offered. Deliberation is required before selecting a blogging platform not only because of the feature differences, but also because if a change of mind were to occur later, shifting the posts from one platform to another will be an arduous task.

The options available to a blogger range from the all-for-free setup offered by Google.com, in the form of its blogger.com-blogspot.com platform-host combo; to the nothing-for-free, Enterprise Moveable Type platform hosted on a paid Web host which requires a person with Web server administration and Perl/MySQL knowledge to manage the blog. Depending on the nature of the blog—personal or organisational, and the object of blogging—hobby or professional, the choice of platform will vary.

In any case it is advisable to try out all platforms by signing up for free accounts or free trial accounts. The platforms which offer a free version for personal use can be downloaded and installed on your PC (along with other requirements like a Web server and other add-ons) or can be uploaded to free web hosts online. Based on the experience with configuring the blog and using it, the platform can be decided upon. Nonetheless, it is important to note there is no relation between the price of the blogging environment and the popularity of the blog. Many freely hosted and created blogs are popular.